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THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE,
RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the function of the Committee,
NOTING regulation 26 of Annex I of MAR POL 73/78 which requires ships to carry a shipboard oil pollution emergency plan in accordance with the Guidelines developed by the Organization,
RECOGNIZING the urgent need for developing such Guidelines in order to ensure uniform application of regulation 26,
HAVING CONSIDERED at its thirty - second session proposals for the Guidelines submitted by Governments,
1. ADOPTS the Guidelines for the development of the shipboard oil spill emergency plan, the text of which is set out at the annex to the present resolution;
2. URGES Governments to take necessary steps to ensure that the shipboard oil spill emergency plans are developed in accordance with these Guidelines

emergency plan, the text of which is set out at the annex to the present resolution;
2. URGES Governments to take necessary steps to ensure that the shipboard oil spill emergency plans are developed in accordance with these Guidelines upon entry into force of regulation 26 of Annex I of MAR POL 73/78.
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These Guidelines, prepared by the Marine Environment Protection Committee of the International Maritime Organization (IMO), contain information for the preparation of shipboard oil pollution emergency plans. These plans are required under regulation 26 of Annex I of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto, as amended (MARPOL 73/78).

required under regulation 26 of Annex I of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto, as amended (MARPOL 73/78).

The main objectives of these Guidelines are:

to assist ship owners in preparing shipboard oil pollution emergency plans that comply with the cited regulation;

to assist Governments in developing and enacting domestic laws which give force to and implement the cited regulation.

In the interest of uniformity, Governments are requested to refer to these Guidelines when preparing appropriate national regulations.

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GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD
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1.1 These Guidelines have been developed to assist with the preparation of the shipboard oil pollution emergency plans (hereafter referred to as the "Plan(s)") that are required by regulation 26 of Annex I of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto, as amended (MARPOL 73/78) (hereafter referred to as the "Convention"). The Plan must be approved in accordance with this regulation.
1.2 The Guidelines are comprised of three primary sections:
.1 Introduction: This section provides a general overview of the subject-matter and introduces the reader to the basic concept of the Guidelines and the Plans that are expected to be developed from them .
. 2 Mandatory provisions: This section provides guidance to ensure that

subject-matter and introduces the reader to the basic concept of the Guidelines and the Plans that are expected to be developed from them .
. 2 Mandatory provisions: This section provides guidance to ensure that the mandatory provisions of regulation 26 of Annex I of the Convention are met .
3 Non-Mandatory provisions: This section provides guidance concerning the inclusion of other information in the Plan. This information, although not required by regulation 26 of Annex I of MARPOL 73/78, may be required by local authorities in ports visited by the ship, or it may be added to provide additional assistance to the ship's master when responding to an emergency situation. This section also provides guidance on updating and exercising of the Plan.
1.3 Concept of Guidelines: These guidelines are intended to provide a starting point for the preparation of the Plans for specific ships. The broad spectrum of ships for which Plans are required makes it impractical to provide specific guidelines for each ship type. Plan writers are cautioned that they must consider in their Plans the many variables that apply to their ships.

spectrum of ships for which Plans are required makes it impractical to provide specific guidelines for each ship type. Plan writers are cautioned that they must consider in their Plans the many variables that apply to their ships. Some of these variables include: type and size of ship, cargo, route, and shore based management structure. The guidelines are not intended to be a compilation of menu items from which the Plan writer can select certain sections and produce a workable Plan. For a Plan to be effective and to comply with regulation 26 of Annex I of the Convention, it must be carefully tailored to the particular ship for which it is intended. Properly used, the guidelines will ensure that all appropriate issues are considered in developing the Plan.

1.4 Concept of the Plan: The Plan is available to assist personnel in dealing with an unexpected discharge of oil. Its primary purpose is to set in motion the necessary actions to stop or minimize the discharge and to mitigate its effects. Effective planning ensures that the necessary actions are taken in a structured, logical and timely manner.

the necessary actions to stop or minimize the discharge and to mitigate its effects. Effective planning ensures that the necessary actions are taken in a structured, logical and timely manner.

1.4.1 The Plan must go beyond providing for operational spills. It must include guidance to assist the master in meeting the demands of a catastrophic discharge, should the ship become involved in one.

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1.4.2 The need for a predetermined and properly structured Plan is clear when one considers the pressures and multiple tasks facing personnel confronted with an emergency situation. In the heat of the moment, lack of planning will often result in confusion, mistakes, and failure to advise key people. Delays will be incurred and time will be wasted; time during which the situation may well worsen. As a consequence, the ship and its personnel may be exposed to increasing hazards and greater environmental damage may occur.

1.4.3 For the Plan to accomplish its purpose, it must be:

well worsen. As a consequence, the ship and its personnel may be exposed to increasing hazards and greater environmental damage may occur.

1.4.3 For the Plan to accomplish its purpose, it must be:

.1 realistic, practical, and easy to use;

.2 understood by ship management personnel, both on board and ashore;

.3 evaluated, reviewed, and updated regularly.

1.4.4 The Plan envisioned by regulation 26 of Annex I to the Convention is intended to be a simple document. Use of summarizing flowcharts or checklists to guide the master through the various actions and decisions required during an incident response is highly encouraged. These can provide a quickly visible and logically sequenced form of information which can reduce error and oversight during emergency situations. Inclusion of extensive background information on the ship, cargo, etc., should be avoided as this is generally available elsewhere. If such information be relevant, it should be kept to annexes where it will not dilute the ability of ship's personnel to locate operative parts of the Plan.

1.4.5 An example of a summarizing flowchart referred to in paragraph 1.4.4

annexes where it will not dilute the ability of ship's personnel to locate operative parts of the Plan.

1.4.5 An example of a summarizing flowchart referred to in paragraph 1.4.4 is included in the Example Format for Shipboard Oil Pollution Emergency Plan at appendix II.

1.4.6 The Plan is likely to be a document used on board by the master and officers of the ship. It must therefore be available in the working language of the master and officers. A change in the master and officers which brings about an attendant change in their working language would require the issue of the Plan in the new language.

2 MANDATORY PROVISIONS OF REGULATION 26 OF ANNEX I TO THE CONVENTION

2.1 This section provides individual guidelines for each of the four mandatory provisions of regulation 26 of Annex I to the Convention.

2.2 Regulation 26 of Annex I to the Convention provides that the Plan shall consist at least of:

.1 the procedure to be followed by the master or other persons having charge of the ship to report an oil pollution incident, as required in article 8 and Protocol I of the present Convention, based on guidelines developed by the Organization~/;

.1 the procedure to be followed by the master or other persons having charge of the ship to report an oil pollution incident, as required in article 8 and Protocol I of the present Convention, based on guidelines developed by the Organization~/;
~I Reference is made to "General principles for ship reporting system and ship reporting requirements, including Guidelines for reporting incidents involving dangerous goods, harmful substances andlor marine pollutants" adopted by the Organization by resolution A.648(16). For ease of reference, see IMO publication "Provisions concerning the Reporting of Incidents Involving Harmful Substances under MAR POL 73/78".
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. 2 the list of authorities or persons to be contacted in the event of an oil pollution incident;
.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and
.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating

.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and
.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating shipboard activities with national and local authorities in combating the pollution.
2.3 The coastal State report: Article 8 and Protocol I of the Convention require that the nearest coastal State be notified of actual or probable discharges. The intent of this requirement is to ensure that coastal States are informed without delay, of any incident giving rise to pollution, or threat of pollution, of the marine environment, as well as of assistance and salvage measures, so that appropriate action may be taken.
2.3.1 When required: The Plan should provide clear, concise guidance to enable the master to determine when a report to the coastal State is required.
2.3.1.1 Actual discharge: A report to the nearest coastal State is required whenever there is:
. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or

whenever there is:
. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or
.2 a discharge during the operation of the ship of oil in excess of the quantity or instantaneous rate permitted under the present Convention.
2.3.1.2 Probable discharge: The Plan should give the master guidance to evaluate a situation which, though not involving an actual discharge, would qualify as a probable discharge and thus require a report. In jUdging whether there is such a probability and whether the report should be made, the following factors, as a minimwn, should be taken into account:
.1 the nature of the damage, failure or breakdown of the ship, machinery or equipment;
. 2 ship location and proximity to land or other navigational hazards;
. 3 weather, tide, current and sea state; and
.4 traffic density.
2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:

2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:
. 1 damage, failure or breakdown which affects the safety of ships; examples of such situations are collision, grounding, fire, explosion, structural failure, flooding, cargo shifting; and
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.2 failure or breakdown of machinery or equipment which results in impairment of the safety of navigation: examples of such incidents are failure or breakdown of steering gear, propulsion, electrical generating system, essential shipborne navigational aids.
2.3.2 Information required: The Plan must specify, in appropriate detail, tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example

tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example of which is included at Appendix II to these Guidelines. Coastal States are encouraged to take note of table 1 of Appendix II and accept this as sufficient initial information. Supplementary or follow-up reports should as far as possible use the same format.

2.4 List of persons to be contacted

2.4.1 The ship involved in a pollution incident will have to communicate with both coastal State or port contacts and ship interests contacts.

2.4.2 When compiling contact lists, due account must be taken of the need to provide 24-hour contact information and to provide alternates to the designated contact. These details must be routinely updated to take account of personnel changes and changes in telephone, telex, and telefax numbers. Clear guidance should also be provided regarding the preferred means of communication (telex, telephone, telefax, etc.)

2.4.3 Coastal State contacts

of personnel changes and changes in telephone, telex, and telefax numbers. Clear guidance should also be provided regarding the preferred means of communication (telex, telephone, telefax, etc.)

2.4.3 Coastal State contacts

2.4.3.1 In order to expedite response and m1n1m1ze damage from a pollution incident, it is essential that appropriate coastal States be notified without delay. This process is begun with the initial report required by article 8 and Protocol I of the Convention. Guidelines for making this report are provided in paragraph 2.3.

2.4.3.2 The Plan should include as an appendix the list of agencies or officials of administrations responsible for receiving and processing reports as developed and updated by the Organization in conformance with article 8 of the Convention. In the absence of a listed focal point, or should any undue delay be experienced in contacting the responsible authority by direct means, the master should be advised to contact the nearest coastal radio station, designated ship movement reporting station or Rescue Co-ordination Centre (RCC) by the quickest available means.

2.4.4 Port contacts

the master should be advised to contact the nearest coastal radio station, designated ship movement reporting station or Rescue Co-ordination Centre (RCC) by the quickest available means.

2.4.4 Port contacts

2.4.4.1 For ships in port, notification of local agencies will speed response. The variety of trades in which ships engage makes it impractical to specify in these guidelines a definitive approach to listing these agencies in the Plan. Information on regularly visited ports should be included as an appendix to the Plan. Where this is not feasible, the Plan should require the master to obtain details concerning local reporting procedures upon arriving in port.

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2.4.5.1 The Plan should provide details of all parties with an interest in the ship to be advised in the event of an incident. This information should be provided in the form of a contact list. When compiling such lists, it should be remembered that in the event of a serious incident, ship's personnel

the ship to be advised in the event of an incident. This information should be provided in the form of a contact list. When compiling such lists, it should be remembered that in the event of a serious incident, ship's personnel will be fully engaged in saving life and taking steps to control and minimize the effects of the casualty. They should therefore not be hampered by having onerous communications requirements imposed on them.

2.4.5.2 Procedures will vary between companies but it is important that the Plan clearly specifies who will be responsible for informing the various interested parties such as cargo owners, insurers and salvage interests. It is also essential that both the ship's Plan and its company's shoreside Plan are co-ordinated to guarantee that all parties having an interest are advised and that duplication of reports is avoided.

2.5 Steps to control discharge

2.5.1 Ship personnel will almost always be in the best position to take quick action to mitigate or control the discharge of oil from their ship. The Plan should provide the master with clear guidance on how to accomplish this

2.5.1 Ship personnel will almost always be in the best position to take quick action to mitigate or control the discharge of oil from their ship. The Plan should provide the master with clear guidance on how to accomplish this mitigation for a variety of situations. The Plan should not only outline action to be taken, but it should also identify who on board is responsible so that confusion during the emergency can be avoided.
2.5.2 This section of the Plan will vary widely from ship to ship. Differences in ship type, construction, cargo, equipment, manning, and even route may result in shifting emphasis being placed on various aspects of this section. As a minimum, the Plan should provide the master with guidance to address the following:
. 1 Operational spills: The Plan should outline the procedures for removal of oil spilled and contained on deck. This may be through the use of on-board resources or by hiring a clean-up company. In either case the Plan should provide guidance to ensure proper disposal of removed oil and clean-up materials .
. 1.1 Pipe leakage: The Plan should provide specific guidance for dealing with pipe leakage .

either case the Plan should provide guidance to ensure proper disposal of removed oil and clean-up materials .

. 1.1 Pipe leakage: The Plan should provide specific guidance for dealing with pipe leakage .

. 1.2 Tank overflow: Procedures for dealing with tank overflows should be included. Alternatives such as lowering cargo or bunkers back to empty or slack tanks or readying pumps to transfer the excess ashore should be outlined .

. 1.3 Hull leakage: The Plan should provide guidance for responding to spillage due to suspected hull leakage. This may involve guidance on measures to be taken to reduce the head of cargo in the tank involved either by internal transfer or discharge ashore. Procedures to handle situations where it is not possible to identify the specific tank from which leakage is occurring should also be provided. Procedures for dealing with suspected hull fractures should be included and they should carry appropriate cautions regarding attention to the effect corrective actions may have on hull stress and stability.

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carry appropriate cautions regarding attention to the effect corrective actions may have on hull stress and stability.
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.2 Spills resulting from casualties: Each of the casualties listed below should be treated in the Plan as a separate section comprised of various checklists or other means which will ensure that the master considers all appropriate factors when addressing the specific casualty. These checklists must be tailored to the specific ship. In addition to the checklists, specific personnel assignments for anticipated tasks must be identified. Reference to existing fire control plans and muster lists is sufficient to identify personnel responsibilities:
. 2.1 grounding;
.2.2 fire/explosion;
.2.3 collision;
.2.4 hull failure;
.2.5 excessive list.
2 . 5.3 In addition to the checklists and personnel duty assignments mentioned in paragraph 2.5.2, the Plan should provide the master with guidance concerning priority actions, stability and stress considerations, and lightening.

2 . 5.3 In addition to the checklists and personnel duty assignments mentioned in paragraph 2.5.2, the Plan should provide the master with guidance concerning priority actions, stability and stress considerations, and lightening.

2.5.3.1 Priority actions: This section provides some general considerations that apply to a wide range of casualties. The Plan should provide ship-specific guidance to the master concerning these broad topics .

. 1 In responding to a casualty, the master's priority will be to ensure the safety of personnel and the ship and to take action to prevent escalation of the incident. In casualties involving spills, immediate consideration should be given to measures aimed at preventing fire and explosion, such as altering course so that the ship is upwind of the slick, shutting down non-essential air intakes, etc. If the ship is aground, and cannot therefore manoeuvre, all possible sources of ignition should be eliminated and action taken to prevent flammable vapours entering accommodation and engine-room spaces. When it is possible to manoeuvre, the master, in conjunction with the appropriate shore authorities,

and action taken to prevent flammable vapours entering accommodation and engine-room spaces. When it is possible to manoeuvre, the master, in conjunction with the appropriate shore authorities, may consider moving his ship to a more suitable location in order, for example, to facilitate emergency repair work or lightening operations, or to reduce the threat posed to any particularly sensitive shoreline areas. Such manoeuvring may be subject to coastal State jurisdiction .

2 Prior to considering remedial action, the master will need to obtain detailed information on the damage sustained by his ship. A visual inspection should be carried out and all cargo tanks, bunker tanks, and other compartments sounded. Due regard should be paid to the indiscriminate opening of ullage plugs or sighting ports, especially when the ship is aground, as loss of buoyancy could result.

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. 3 Having assessed the damage sustained by the ship, the master will be in a position to decide what action should be taken to prevent

. 3 Having assessed the damage sustained by the ship, the master will be in a position to decide what action should be taken to prevent or minimize further spillage. When bottom damage is sustained, hydrostatic balance will be achieved fairly rapidly, especially if the damage is severe, in which case the time available for preventive action will often be limited. When significant side damage is sustained in the way of oil tanks, cargo or bunkers will be released fairly rapidly until hydrostatic balance is achieved and the rate of release will then reduce and be governed by the rate at which oil is displaced by water flowing in under the oil. When the damage is fairly limited and restricted, for example, to one or two compartments, consideration may be given to transferring oil internally from damaged to intact tanks.

2.5.3.2 Stability and stress considerations: Great care in casualty response must be taken to consider stability and stress when taking actions to mitigate the spillage of oil or to free the ship if aground. The Plan should provide

2.5.3.2 Stability and stress considerations: Great care in casualty response must be taken to consider stability and stress when taking actions to mitigate the spillage of oil or to free the ship if aground. The Plan should provide the master with detailed guidance to ensure that these aspects are properly considered. Nothing in this section shall be construed as creating a requirement for damage stability plans or calculations beyond those required by relevant international conventions .

. 1 Internal transfers should be undertaken only with a full appreciation of the likely impact on the ship's overall stress and stability. When the damage sustained is extensive, the impact of internal transfers on stress and stability may be impossible for the ship to assess. Contact may have to be made with the owner or operator or other entity in order that information can be provided so that damage stability and damaged longitudinal strength assessments may be made. These could be made within the head office technical departments. In other cases, classification societies or independent organizations may need to be contacted. The Plan should

assessments may be made. These could be made within the head office technical departments. In other cases, classification societies or independent organizations may need to be contacted. The Plan should clearly indicate who the master should contact in order to gain access to these facilities
. 2 Where appropriate, the Plan should provide a list of information required for making damage stability and damaged longitudinal strength assessments.
2.5.3.3 Lightening: Should the ship sustain extensive structural damage, it may be necessary to transfer all or part of the cargo to another ship. The Plan should provide guidance on procedures to be followed for ship-to-ship transfer of cargo. Reference may be made in the Plan to existing company guides. A copy of such company procedures for ship-to-ship transfer operations should be kept with the Plan. The Plan should address the need for co-ordinating this activity with the coastal State, as such operation may be subject to its jurisdiction.
2.5.4 In order to have the necessary information available to respond to the situations referred to in paragraph 2.5.2, certain plans, drawings, and

subject to its jurisdiction.
2.5.4 In order to have the necessary information available to respond to the situations referred to in paragraph 2.5.2, certain plans, drawings, and ship-specific details such as, a layout of a general arrangement plan, a tank plan, etc., should be appended. The Plan should show where current cargo, bunker and ballast information, including quantities and specifications, are available.
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2.6 National and local co-ordination: Quick, efficient co-ordination between the ship and coastal State or other involved parties becomes vital in mitigating the effects of a pollution incident. The Plan should address the need to contact the coastal State for authorization prior to undertaking mitigating actions.
2.6.1 The identities and roles of various national and local authorities involved vary widely from State to State and even from port to port. Approaches to responsibility for discharge response also vary. Some coastal

mitigating actions.

2.6.1 The identities and roles of various national and local authorities involved vary widely from State to State and even from port to port. Approaches to responsibility for discharge response also vary. Some coastal States have agencies that take charge of response immediately and subsequently bill the owner for the cost. In other coastal States, responsibility for initiating response is placed on the shipowner. In the case of the latter the Plan will require greater detail and guidance to assist the master with organizing this response.

3 NON-MANDATORY PROVISIONS

3.1 In addition to the provisions required by regulation 26 of Annex I of the Convention, local requirements, insurance company, or owner/operator policies, etc., may dictate that other guidance be provided in the Plan. These topics may include: provision of diagrams and drawings; ship carried response equipment; public affairs; record-keeping; and reference materials.

3.2 Plans and diagrams: In addition to the plans required by section 2.5.4 above, other details concerning the ship's design and construction may be appended to the Plan or their location identified.

3.2 Plans and diagrams: In addition to the plans required by section 2.5.4 above, other details concerning the ship's design and construction may be appended to the Plan or their location identified.
3.3 Response equipment: Some ships may carryon board equipment to assist in pollution response. The type and quantity of this equipment may vary widely. The Plan should indicate an inventory of such equipment, if carried. It should also provide directions for safe use and guidelines to assist the master in determining when such use is warranted. Care should be exercised to ensure that the use of such equipment by the crew is practical and consistent with safety considerations. When such equipment is carried, the Plan should establish personnel responsibilities for its deployment, oversight, and maintenance. In order to ensure safe and effective use of such equipment, the Plan should also provide for crew training in the use of it. The Plan should include a provision that no chemical agent should be used for response to pollution on the sea without authorization of the appropriate coastal State and that such authorization should also be requested, when required, for use

should include a provision that no chemical agent should be used for response to pollution on the sea without authorization of the appropriate coastal State and that such authorization should also be requested, when required, for use of containment or recovery equipment.

3.4 Public affairs: The owners may want to include in the Plan guidance for the master in dealing with the distribution of information to the news media. Such guidance should be fashioned to reduce the burden on ship's personnel already busy with the emergency at hand.

3.5 Record-keeping: As with any other incident that will eventually involve liability, compensation and reimbur~ement issues, the bwner may want to include in his Plan guidance for the keeping of appropriate records of the pollution incident. Apart from detailing all actions taken on board, records might include communications with outside authorities, owners, and other parties, as well as a brief summary of decisions and information passed and received. Guidance on collecting of samples of spilled oil as well as that carried on board may also be provided.

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received. Guidance on collecting of samples of spilled oil as well as that carried on board may also be provided.
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3.6 Plan review: Regular review of the Plan by the owner, operator or master is recommended to ensure that the specific information contained therein is current. A feedback system should be employed which will allow quick capture of changing information and incorporation of it into the Plan. This feedback system should incorporate the following two means:
.1 periodic review: the Plan should be reviewed by the owner or operator at least yearly to capture changes in local law or policy, contact names and numbers, ship characteristics, or company policy;
.2 event review: after any use of the Plan in response to an incident, its effectiveness should be evaluated by the owner or operator and modifications made accordingly.
3.7 Plan testing: The Plan will be of little value if it is not made familiar to the personnel who will use it. Regular exercises will ensure that the Plan

modifications made accordingly.
3.7 Plan testing: The Plan will be of little value if it is not made familiar to the personnel who will use it. Regular exercises will ensure that the Plan functions as expected and that the contacts and communications specified are accurate. Such exercises may be held in conjunction with other shipboard exercises and appropriately logged. Where Ships carry response equipment, hands on experience with it by crew members will greatly enhance safety and effectiveness in an emergency situation. Procedures for training and exercise may be defined.
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The following publications are suggested to provide additional assistance in the preparation of Plans:
Manual on Oil Pollution, Section II, Contingency Planning
International Maritime Organization (IMO)
ISBN 92 801 1233 3
Available in English, French, and Spanish from IMO, publications Section, 4 Albert Embankment, London SEI 7SR
Response to Marine Oil Spills
International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF)

ISBN 92 801 1233 3
Available in English, French, and Spanish from IMO, publications Section,
4 Albert Embankment, London SEI 7SR
Response to Marine Oil Spills
International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF)
ISBN 0 948691 51 4
Available in English, French, and Spanish from Witherby & Co. Ltd.,
32-36 Aylesbury Street, London ECIR OET
Provisions Concerning the Reporting of Incidents Involving Harmful Substances under MARPOL 73/78
IMO
ISBN 92 801 1261 9
Available in English, French and Spanish from IMO Publications Section
International Safety Guide for Oil Tankers and Terminals
ISBN 0 948691 62 X
Available from Witherby & Co. Ltd., London
Peril at Sea and Salvage -- A Guide for Masters
International Chamber of Shipping and Oil Companies International Marine Forum (ICS/OCIMF)
ISBN 0 948691 46 8
Available from Witherby & Co. Ltd., London
Ship to Ship Transfer Guide (Petroleum)
ICS/OCIMF
ISBN 0 948691 36 0
Available from Witherby & Co. Ltd., London
Guidelines for the Preparation of Shipboard Oil Spill Contingency Plans
OCIMF/ITOPF
ISBN 1 85609 016 7
Available from Witherby & Co. Ltd., London

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W/6725D/EWP
RESOLUTION MEPC.54(32)
adopted on 6 March 1992
GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD
OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSW/6725D/EWP
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EXAMPLE FORMAT FOR SHIPBOARD OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLAN
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All shipboard oil pollution emergency plans should contain the following introductory text:
"INTRODUCTION
1 This Plan is written in accordance with the requirements of regulation 26 of Annex I of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the ~rotocol of 1978 relating thereto.
2 The purpose of the Plan i~ to provi~e guidance to the master and officers on board the ship with respect to the steps to be taken when a pollution incident has occurred or is likely to occur.

2 The
on board
incident
purpose of the Plan i~ to provi~e guidance to the master and officers
the ship with respect to the steps to be taken when a pollution
has occurred or is likely to occur.
3 The Plan contains all information and operational instructions required
by the Guidelines. The appendices contain names, telephone, telex numbers,
etc., of all contacts referenced in the Plan, as well as other reference
material.
4 This Plan has been approved by the Administration and, except as provided
below, no alteration or revision shall be made to any part of it without the
prior approval of the Administration.
5 Changes to Section 5 and the appendices will not be required to be
approved by the Administration. The appendices should be maintained up to
date by the owners, operators and managers."
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Preamble
Reporting requirements
2.1 When to report
2.2 Information required
2.3 Who to contact
Steps to control discharge
3.1 Operational spills

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SECTION 1: PREAMBLE
1 This section should contain an explanation of the purpose and use of the Plan and indicate how the shipboard Plan relates to other shore-based plans (refer Section 1.4 of the Guidelines).
SECTION 2: REPORTING REQUIREMENTS
2 This section should ensure that the reporting requirements of regulation 26 of Annex I of MAR POL 73/78 are complied with and should include information relating to the following:
2.1 When to report
This section should contain guidance on when to report actual andlor probable discharges (see section 2.3.1 of the Guidelines).
2.2 Information required

include information relating to the following:
2.1 When to report
This section should contain guidance on when to report actual andlor probable discharges (see section 2.3.1 of the Guidelines).
2.2 Information required
This section should contain details of the information required for the initial report and supplementary or follow-up reports. Reference should be made to resolution A.648(16) (see section 2.3.2 of the Guidelines). This section should include an example of reporting format as illustrated in table 1.
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GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSTABLE 1
SHIPBOARD OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLAN
SAMPLE FORMAT fOR INIIIAL NOTIFICATION
AA !SHIP NAME. CALL S I G~. f lAG)
B6 (DATE AND TIME OF EVENI . UTC)
1-1-1-1_1-1_1
0 0 H H M M
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ANNEX 4
Page 19
CC {PQSITIQN . LAT . lO~GI OR 00 (B EARI ~ . DISTANCE FROM lAMDMARK)
1
1-1---1---1-1 N 1 S 1 1 l~l~l-l 1 1
d d m m 1 d d d N miles
1 1
1-1-1-1-1-1 E 1 w 1 1
d d d m m 1
EE !COURSE) 1 FF (SPEEQ. K~OIS)
1
1---1-1-1 1 1- 1- 1- 1
d d d 1 kn kn 1110
Ll (INTENDED TRACK)
MM (RAQIO STATIONS{S} GUARQEQl

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d d m m 1 d d d N miles
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d d d 1 kn kn 1110
LI (INTENDED TRACK)
MM (RAQIO STATIONS{S} GUARQEQI
NN (DATE AND TIME OF NEXT REPQRT. UTC)
1-1-1-1-1-1-1 0 D H H M M
PP (TYPE AND QUA~TITY OF CABGQLBUNKERS ON BOARD)
00 !BRIEF DETAILS Of D E F ECI SLOEF I C1 E~CIESLDAMAGEI
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TABLE 1 (continued)
RH {BHI EF DETAILS QF PQLLUTIQN, INCLUDING ESTIMAIE OF QUANTITY LOSTI
SS {BRIEF DETAILS OF WEATHER AND SEA CONDITIONSI
r DIRECTION 1-1-1_1 r DIRECTION
WIND 1 SWELL 1 L SPEED (Beaufort) L HEIGHT
TT (CQNTACT DETAI ~S OF SHIP'S QWNEBLOPEB8IQRLAGENI I
UU (SHIP SIZE AND TYPE)
LENGTH: (m) BREADTH: (m) DRAUGHT: (m) TYPE:
XX (ADDITIONAL INfORMATION)
BRIEF DETAILS Of INCIDENT:
NEED fOR OUTSIDE ASSISTANCE:
ACTIONS BEING TAKEN:
NUMBER Of CREW AND DETAILS Of ANY INJURIES:
DETAILS OF P&I CLUB & LOCAL CORRESPONDENT:
OTHERS:
1-1-1-1
(m)

XX (ADDITIONAL INfORMATION)
BRIEF DETAILS Of INCIDENT:
NEED fOR OUTSIDE ASSISTANCE:
ACTIONS BEING TAKEN:
NUMBER Of CREW AND DETAILS Of ANY INJURIES:
DETAILS OF P&I CLUB & LOCAL CORRESPONDENT:
OTHERS:
1-1-1-1
(m)
Footnote: The alphabetical reference letters in the above format are from "General principles for ship reporting systems and ship reporting requirements, including guidelines for reporting incidents involving dangerous goods, harmful substances and/or marine pollutants" adopted by the International Maritime Organization by resolution A.648(16). The letters do not follow the complete alphabetical sequence as certain letters are used to designate information required for other standard reporting formats, e.g., those used to transmit route information.
2.3 Who to contact
This section should refer the Plan user to Appendices separately listing contacts for the following:
coastal State contacts (see section 2.4.2 of the Guidelines);
port contacts (see section 2.4.3 of the Guidelines); and
ship interest contacts (see section 2.4.4 of the Guidelines),
Examples of how this information could be depicted are included in the appendices.
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port contacts (see section 2.4.3 of the Guidelines); and
ship interest contacts (see section 2.4.4 of the Guidelines),
Examples of how this information could be depicted are included in the appendices.
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SECTION 3: STEPS TO CONTROL DISCHARGE
3 This section should ensure that the prov1s10ns of regulation 26 of Annex 1 of MAR POL 73/78 regarding steps to control discharge are complied with and should include information relating to the following:
3.1 Ope r ational spills
This section should contain ship-specific information concerning actions to be taken in response to operational spills (see section 2.5.2.1). As a minimum, procedures to address spills resulting from pipe leakage, tank overflow and hull leakage should be included.
3.2 Spills resulting from casualties
This section should contain ship-specific and company-specific information concerning actions to be taken to address, as a minimum, the following casualty scenarios: grounding, fire/explosion,

be included.
3.2 Spills resulting from casualties
This section should contain ship-specific and company-specific information concerning actions to be taken to address, as a minimum, the following casualty scenarios: grounding, fire/explosion, collision, hull failure, excessive list (see section 2.5.2.2 of the Guidelines). This section should also provide guidance on priority actions to be taken (see Section 2.5 of the Guidelines). Consideration should be given to providing some of the necessary information in the form of checklists/flowcharts where considered applicable. An example of presentation of information relating to response activities and personnel responsibilities is given in table 2 below:
Operational Designated Crew Member
spi 11 type Action to be taken (State rank/rating only)
Pipe leakage Stop product flow Chi ef Offi cer
~ ~----- / -~-
c
-- ..... -
Where appropriate this section should provide a list of information required for making damage stability and damage longitudinal strength assessments.
SECTION 4: NATIONAL AND LOCAL CO-ORDINATION
4 This section should contain information to assist the master in

required for making damage stability and damage longitudinal strength assessments.

SECTION 4: NATIONAL AND LOCAL CO-ORDINATION

4 This section should contain information to assist the master in initiating action by coastal State, local government or other involved parties (see section 2.6 of the Guidelines). Dependent on the ship's trade, this Section should include information and guidance to assist the master with organizing a response to the incident should such response not be organized by shore authorities. Detailed information for specific areas may be included as appendices to the Plan.

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SECTION 5: ADDITIONAL INFORMATION (NON-MANDATORY)

5 This section should contain additional information included in the Plan at the owners' discretion. This information, although not required by regulation 26 of MAR POL 73/78, Annex 1, may be required by local authorities in ports visited by the vessel, or it may be included to provide additional

at the owners' discretion. This information, although not required by regulation 26 of MAR POL 73/78, Annex 1, may be required by local authorities in ports visited by the vessel, or it may be included to provide additional assistance to the ship's master when responding to an emergency situation.
This information may include (see section 3 of the Guidelines):
plan review procedures;
training and drill procedures;
record-keeping procedures;
public affairs policy of the owners/operators;
etc.
(See section 3 of the Guidelines.)
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The following appendices should be attached to the Plan, as a minimuml
List o.f coastal State contacts (see section 2.4.3 of the Guidelinell)
List of port contacts as appropriate (see section 2.4.4 of the Guidelines)
List of ship interest contacts (see section 2.4.5 of the Guidelines)
Ship's plans and drawings (see section 2.5.4 of the Guidelines).
Additionally the following information could be attached I

Guidelines)
List of ship interest contacts (see section 2.4.5 of the Guidelines)
Ship's plans and drawings (see section 2.5.4 of the Guidelines).
Additionally the following information could be attached I
Summary flowchart (consideration should be given to adapting the
flowchart for bulkhead display on board)
Information relevant to roles and responsibilities of national and
local authorities
Other reference material
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APPENDIX
SHIP INTEREST CONTACTS
The following table provides an example as to how ship interest contact
information could be presented:
(a) Owner/operator contacts
Name of institution/
person to be contacted
Owner/operator
Address
(b) Othe r ship inter es t c ont acts
Name of institution/
person to be contacted
Charterer
Local agent
Address
---'---. - --------- -----
P&I Club and
correspondents
Means of contact
Phone:
fax:
Telex: ....
INMARSAT-
Telex: ... .
INMARSAT-
fax:
Means of contact
Remarks
Remarks
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P&I Club and
correspondents
Means of contact
Phone:
fax:
Telex: ....
INMARSAT-
Telex: ... .
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fax:
Means of contact
Remarks
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SHIPBOARD OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLAN - SUMMARY fLOWCHART
This flow diagram is an outline of the course of action that shipboard personnel should follow in responding to an oil pollution emergency based on the guidelines published by the Organization. This diagram is not exhaustive and should not be used as a sole reference in response. Consideration should be given for inclusion of specific references to the Plan. The steps are designed to assist ship personnel in actions to stop or minimize the discharge of oil and mitigate its effects. These steps fall into two main categories - reporting and action.
ASSESSMENT Of THE NATURE Of INCIDENT
1
ACTIONS REQUIRED
'" Alert crew members
'" Identify spill source
'" SDi11 assessment

steps fall into two main categories - reporting and action.
ASSESSMENT Of THE NATURE Of INCIDENT
1
ACTIONS REQUIRED
'" Alert crew members
'" Identify spill source
'" SDi11 assessment
.-_____ _____ _____ ~I -. r--~I ----------_,
RE~ORTING
Bv Master and/or desianahd crew member
WHEN TO REPORT
All probable and actual spills
HOW TO REPORI
'" By quickest means to coastal radio
station
'" Designated ship movement reporting
station or
'" Rescue Co-ordination Centre (at sea)
'" By quickest available means to
local authorities
WHO TO CONTACT
* Nearest coastal State
* Harbour and terminal operators
(in port)
* Shipowner's manager; P & I insurer
" Head Charterer; cargo owner
" Refer to contact lists
WHAT TO REPORT
" Initial report (Res.648(16))
" follow-up reports
'" Characteristics of oil spilled
* Cargo/ballast/bunker dispositions
* Weather and sea conditions
" Slick movement
" Assistance required
- Salvage
- Lightening capacity
- Mechanical equipment
- External strike team
- Chemical dispersant/degreasant
I ...
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ACTION TO CONTROL DISCHARGE
Measures to minimize the escape of oil and threat
to the marine environment

- Salvage
- Lightening capacity
- Mechanical equipment
- External strike team
- Chemical dispersant/degreasant
I ...
W/6725D/EWP
ACTION TO CONTROL DISCHARGE
Measures to minimize the escape of oil and threat
to the marine environment
NAVIGATIONAL MEASURES
* Alter course/position
and/or speed
'" Change of list and/or
trim
" Anchoring
'" Setting aground
'" Initiate towage
" Assess safe haven
requirements
'" Weather/tide/swell
forecasting
" Slick monitoring
'" Record of events and
communications taken
SEAMANSHIP MEASURES
'" Safety assessment and
precaution
'" Advice on priority
countermeasures/
preventive measures
" Damage stability and
stress considerations
" Ba11asting/deba11asting
'" Internal cargo transfer
operations
'" Emergency ship-to-ship
transfers of cargo
and/or bunker
'" Set up shipboard
response for:
- Leak sealing
- fire fighting
- Handling of shipboard
response equipment
(if available)
- etc .
STEPS TO INITIATE EXTERNAL RESPONSE
'" Refer to coastal Port State listings for local
assistance
'" Refer to ship interest contact list
" External clean-up resources required
'" Continued monitorino of activities
., I

(if available)
- etc .
STEPS TO INITIATE EXTERNAL RESPONSE
'" Refer to coastal Port State listings for local
assistance
'" Refer to ship interest contact list
" External clean-up resources required
'" Continued monitorino of activities
., I
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